

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 8 5
♥ A 2
♦ 9 7 5 4 2
♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ K J 5

♦ A 8 3

♣ 10 7 6



♠ 6 3

♥ 9 8 6 4 3

♦ Q 10

♣ J 5 4 2

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ K J 6

♣ A K 8 3

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♣

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You dealt this hand.

This would be an ideal hand to open 1NT - well, it would be with one less point. But with 18 you are too strong to open 1NT so you open 1 ♣. Partner responds 1 ♠.

DO NOT fall into the trap of supporting partner's ♠s just because you have such nice help for him. He might have a 4-card suit. Instead, just describe your hand by jumping to 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 18-19 points. Partner now bids 3NT and you play it there.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8
♥ 9 8 4
♦ A K 7 2
♣ 10 9 6 5

♠ Q J 6

♥ A K 7

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ A K 8



♠ 5 3

♥ 10 6 3 2

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ Q J 2

♠ K 10 9 7 4 2

♥ Q J 5

♦ 3

♣ 7 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

You dealt this hand.

You open 1♦ and partner responds 1♠. What is your next bid?

Do not support what may be a 4-card suit with only 3 cards. Instead, jump to 2NT, showing 18-19, balanced. Partner rebids the ♠s. What do you say next?

Partner shows a minimum hand, but with 6 ♠s. 3NT is very tempting, and might work out fine, but with 9 ♠s it is probably better to play the suit game. So you bid 4♠ and everybody passes.

Bidding 4♠ was a good choice. It makes easily, yet 3NT might have gone down.